

# Session 14: The Lord's Prayer

## Key Takeaways

- Jesus wants us to see that every day is another trial before the tree in the garden, and he invites us to seek God's deliverance either from the test or from falling prey to the voice of the evil one.
- The closing doxology to the Lord's Prayer (i.e., "For yours is the kingdom and the power and the glory forever. Amen.") is not present in the earliest available manuscripts of the New Testament and is therefore omitted from many modern translations. However, its use in the liturgical practice of the Church is attested as early as the late 1st century.
- The theme of God's name being recognized as holy runs throughout the whole Bible. God's name is profaned by the unfaithfulness of his people, so Jesus instructs us to ask for God's help in upholding the holiness of his name.
- The story of the Bible as a whole and of Jesus' own life is woven throughout the words and themes of the Lord's Prayer.

## The Prayer of Jesus

### The Lord's Prayer

#### Addressed to "You" the Father

Our Father who is in the skies,  
**may your name** be recognized as holy,  
**may your kingdom** come,  
**and may your desire** be done,  
as it is in the skies,  
so also on the land.

#### How "We" Can Participate in the Father's Kingdom and Will

##### Provision

Our daily provision of bread,  
give to us today.

##### Forgiveness

And forgive us our debts,

just as we also have forgiven those indebted to us.

### **Deliverance**

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And don't lead us to be tested,  
but deliver us from the evil one.

*Matthew 6:9-13. Translation and Literary Design by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: The Messianic Torah (2024).*

The prayer is a 12-line poem, divided into two halves of six lines, each a triad of three pairs, with a total of seven requests.

The first half is a series of requests addressed to the Father about his reputation and purposes in the world. The second half is a series of requests by "us/we" focused on three daily realities: survival, relationships, and the challenges of remaining faithful to God's will.

## **The Form of the Lord's Prayer**

The Lord's prayer occurs twice in the New Testament: Matthew 6:9-13 and Luke 11:2-4. The additional elements in Matthew are highlighted:

### **Matthew 6:9-13** Instructor's Translation

Our Father **in heaven,**  
hallowed be your name,  
your kingdom come,  
**your will be done on earth as it is in heaven.**  
Give us today our daily bread.  
Forgive us our debts,  
as we also have forgiven our debtors.  
And lead us not into the time of testing,  
**but deliver us from evil.**

### **Luke 11:2-4** Instructor's Translation

Father,  
hallowed be your name,  
your kingdom come.  
Give us each day our daily bread.  
Forgive us our sins,  
for we also forgive everyone who sins against us.  
And lead us not into the time of testing.

There are multiple explanations for these differences. The two opposite ends of the explanation spectrum are:

1. That Luke preserves an earlier (and shorter) form of the prayer, and that Matthew (or the source which he used) added the extra lines to contextualize it into the themes of his account.

2. That Jesus would have taught a prayer like this on multiple occasions to many different audiences, not always adhering to the same words, but to the basic ideas. Thus, Matthew and Luke preserve two different traditions of the prayer.

“Quite probably, the prayer was handed down in slightly differing versions in churches of different geographic regions.”

Hagner, Donald (1993). [Matthew 1-13 \(Word Biblical Commentary\)](#). Thomas Nelson Inc. 145.

| Syriac                                         | Aramaic                                      | Transliterated                                                                    | Greek New Testament                                                                          | English Translation                                                                                                    |
|------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ܐܒܘܢ ܕܒܫܡܝܐ                                    | ܐܒܘܢ ܕܒܫܡܝܐ                                  | avun<br>devashmaya'                                                               | Πάτερ ἡμῶν ὁ ἐν<br>τοῖς οὐρανοῖς,                                                            | <sup>9</sup> Our Father who<br>is in the skies,                                                                        |
| ܐܒܝܬܐ ܕܡܠܚܬܐ<br>ܕܡܠܚܬܐ ܕܡܠܚܬܐ<br>ܕܡܠܚܬܐ ܕܡܠܚܬܐ | ܢܬܩܕܝܫ ܫܡܕ<br>ܬܐܬܬܐ ܡܠܚܬܐ<br>ܢܗܝܐ ܥܒܝܕܐ      | nethqaddash<br>shemakh<br>te'ethe'<br>malkhuthak<br>nehwe'<br>tsivyonakh          | ἁγιασθήτω τὸ<br>ὄνομά σου.<br>ἐλθέτω ἡ βασιλεία<br>σου<br>γενηθήτω τὸ<br>θέλημά σου,         | may your name<br>be recognized as<br>holy,<br><sup>10</sup> may your<br>kingdom come,<br>and may your will<br>be done, |
| ܐܝܚܢܐ ܕܒܫܡܝܐ<br>ܐܝܚܢܐ ܕܒܫܡܝܐ                   | ܐܝܚܢܐ ܕܒܫܡܝܐ<br>ܐܝܚܢܐ ܕܒܫܡܝܐ                 | 'aykhana'<br>devashmaya'<br>'aph ba'r'a'                                          | ὡς ἐν οὐρανῷ<br>καὶ ἐπὶ γῆς.                                                                 | as it is in the<br>skies,<br>so also on the<br>land.                                                                   |
| ܬܝܒ ܕܝܚܝܐ<br>ܕܝܚܝܐ ܕܝܚܝܐ                       | ܬܝܒ ܕܝܚܝܐ<br>ܕܝܚܝܐ ܕܝܚܝܐ                     | hab lan lakhma'<br>desunqanan<br>yawmana'                                         | Τὸν ἄρτον ἡμῶν<br>τὸν ἐπιούσιον<br>δὸς ἡμῖν σήμερον.                                         | <sup>11</sup> Our daily<br>provision of<br>bread,<br>give to us today.                                                 |
| ܐܝܚܢܐ ܕܒܫܡܝܐ<br>ܐܝܚܢܐ ܕܒܫܡܝܐ<br>ܐܝܚܢܐ ܕܒܫܡܝܐ   | ܐܝܚܢܐ ܕܒܫܡܝܐ<br>ܐܝܚܢܐ ܕܒܫܡܝܐ<br>ܐܝܚܢܐ ܕܒܫܡܝܐ | washvuq lan<br>khawvanan<br>'aykhana' de'aph<br>khanan<br>shevaqan<br>lekhayabayn | καὶ ἄφες ἡμῖν τὰ<br>ὀφειλήματα ἡμῶν,<br>ὡς καὶ ἡμεῖς<br>ἀφήκαμεν<br>τοῖς ὀφειλέταις<br>ἡμῶν. | <sup>12</sup> And forgive us<br>our debts,<br>just as we also<br>have forgiven<br>those indebted to<br>us.             |

The Lord's Prayer in Different Translations. Created by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: The Messianic Torah (2024).

| Syriac                                                                 | Aramaic                                                                | Transliterated                                                                         | Greek New Testament                                                                   | English Translation                                                                                              |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ܐܠܗܐ ܕܢܝܢܐ<br>ܕܠܥܠܐ ܕܢܝܢܐ<br>ܕܠܥܠܐ ܕܢܝܢܐ                               | ܐܠܗܐ ܕܢܝܢܐ<br>ܕܠܥܠܐ ܕܢܝܢܐ<br>ܕܠܥܠܐ ܕܢܝܢܐ                               | la' ta 'alan<br>lenesyona'<br>'ela' phatsa' lan<br>men bisha'                          | καὶ μὴ εἰσενέγκῃς<br>ἡμᾶς εἰς πειρασμόν,<br>ἀλλὰ ῥῦσαι ἡμᾶς<br>ἀπὸ τοῦ πονηροῦ.       | <sup>13</sup> And don't lead<br>us to be tested,<br>but deliver us<br>from the evil one.                         |
| ܡܬܠ ܕܕܠܚܐ ܗܝ<br>ܡܠܟܘܬܐ ܕܝܚܝܐ<br>ܘܬܫܒܘܚܬܐ<br>ܕܠܥܠܐ ܕܢܝܢܐ<br>ܕܠܥܠܐ ܕܢܝܢܐ | ܡܬܠ ܕܕܠܚܐ ܗܝ<br>ܡܠܟܘܬܐ ܕܝܚܝܐ<br>ܘܬܫܒܘܚܬܐ<br>ܕܠܥܠܐ ܕܢܝܢܐ<br>ܕܠܥܠܐ ܕܢܝܢܐ | metul d'dilakh hai<br>malkhuthakh<br>wekhaila<br>wateshvukhtha<br>l'alam almin<br>amen | οτι σου εστιν<br>η βασιλεια και η<br>δυναμις<br>και η δοξα<br>εις τους αιωνας<br>αμην | Because to you<br>belongs the<br>kingdom, and the<br>power,<br>and the praise<br>for the age of<br>ages.<br>Amen |

*The Lord's Prayer in Different Translations. Created by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: The Messianic Torah (2024).*

Note: the Aramaic in this chart—its transliteration and pronunciation in the session—is one attempt at capturing how this prayer would have sounded. Different liturgical traditions render the vocalization of this prayer differently.

## Historical and Cultural Background of Jesus’ Prayer

In Jewish culture of this period, it was very common for rabbis to teach memorable prayers to their small groups of disciples so that the rabbi’s teachings could be easily recalled and summarized. Additionally, liturgical daily prayer was a crucial component of Jewish life. Here, Jesus is adopting language from a Jewish prayer that was recited in Aramaic at the conclusion of synagogue services, known as the Qaddish.

“May his [= God’s] great name be exalted and hallowed  
in the world which he created according to his will.  
May he establish his kingdom  
in your lifetime and in your days  
and in the lifetime of the house of Israel  
speedily and soon.  
And say, 'Amen.'”

Elbogen, Ismar (1993). [Jewish Liturgy: A Comprehensive History](#). Jewish Publication Society. 92-98.

The Qaddish prayer has many similar themes to the Lord’s Prayer: It recognizes that at present, God’s reputation and Kingdom are not established in the world. It is a petition that God would act in history to turn his plans into reality. It uses the language of God’s “name” (i.e., his reputation) and his “Kingdom.”

The primary difference between the prayers is this: While the Qaddish is a petition that God would act in the future, the Lord's Prayer is for followers who confess that God has already begun to bring his Kingdom in and through Jesus. In other words, the Lord's Prayer is a petition that God continue to do what he has already started in Jesus.

We have evidence from the end of the 1st century that Christians prayed this prayer three times daily (mentioned in the early Christian text, *The Didache* 8:3), just as Jews prayed the Shema (a prayer based on *Deuteronomy* 6:4-5) three times a day.

"2 And do not pray as the wicked [do]; pray instead this way, as the Lord directed in his gospel:

Our Father who are in heaven,  
May your name be acclaimed as holy,  
May your kingdom come,  
May your will come to pass  
on earth as it does in heaven.  
Give us today our daily bread,  
And cancel for us our debt,  
As we cancel [debts] for those who are indebted to us,  
And do not bring us into temptation,  
But preserve us from the evil one.  
For power and glory are yours forever.

3 Pray this way thrice daily."

Niederwimmer, Kurt & Attridge, Harold W. (1998). [\*The Didache: A Commentary \(Hermeneia\)\*](#). Fortress Press. 134.

## Interpretation of the Key Lines of the Prayer

"May your name be recognized as sacred" = "Hallowed be your name"

- Older English for "May your name be considered/recognized as sacred/set apart/distinct."
- "Hallowed/treated/recognized as holy" means that Yahweh's reputation is honored among the nations, so that Yahweh alone is recognized as creator and king.

### **Psalm 18:49 NASB**

Therefore I will give thanks to you **among the nations**,  
O LORD, and I will sing praises to **your name**.

### **Psalm 96:2-3 NASB**

Sing to the LORD, bless **his name**;  
proclaim good tidings of his salvation from day to day.  
Tell of his glory **among the nations**,  
his wonderful deeds **among all the peoples**.

### **Psalm 105:1 NASB**

Oh give thanks to the LORD, call upon **his name**;  
make known his deeds **among the peoples**.

### **Isaiah 12:4 LEB**

And you will say on that day, "Give thanks to Yahweh; call on **his name**.  
Make his deeds known **among the peoples**;  
bring to remembrance that **his name** is exalted."

The passive "be recognized/treated as holy" (Greek: *hagiastheto*) could be construed in two ways.

1. Divine passive: i.e., an action that God will perform himself. In this case, "make known the holiness, uniqueness of your name", is a plea for God to act in history and make known his power and goodness.
2. A genuine passive: i.e., an action that others will perform. This would play out as, "make your name recognized as holy/unique among Israel and the nations". Probably, Jesus intends both.

The request that God's name be recognized as holy assumes some kind of story in which God's name is not (or not currently) being treated as sacred. The recognition of Yahweh's "name" is rooted in the story of the Old Testament.

When Yahweh delivered Israel out of slavery in Egypt, it was in order that "my name might be proclaimed through all the earth" (Exod. 9:16). Israel's violation of their covenant with Yahweh, and their exile and subjugation among the nations, has resulted in God's name being "profaned, violated, dishonored."

### **Psalm 74:1-10 NASB**

- <sup>1</sup> O God, why have you rejected us forever?  
Why does your anger smoke against the sheep of your pasture?
- <sup>2</sup> Remember your congregation, which you have purchased of old,  
which you have redeemed to be the tribe of your inheritance;  
and this Mount Zion, where you have dwelt.
- <sup>3</sup> Turn your footsteps toward the perpetual ruins;  
the enemy has damaged everything within the sanctuary.
- <sup>4</sup> Your adversaries have roared in the midst of your meeting place;  
they have set up their own standards for signs.
- <sup>5</sup> It seems as if one had lifted up  
his axe in a forest of trees.
- <sup>6</sup> And now all its carved work  
they smash with hatchet and hammers.
- <sup>7</sup> They have burned your sanctuary to the ground;  
they have defiled the dwelling place of your name.
- <sup>8</sup> They said in their heart, "Let us completely subdue them."  
They have burned all the meeting places of God in the land.
- <sup>9</sup> We do not see our signs;  
there is no longer any prophet,

nor is there any among us who knows how long.

<sup>10</sup> How long, O God, will the adversary revile,  
and the enemy **show contempt for your name** forever?

### Isaiah 52:4-6 NASB

For thus says the Lord God, "My people went down at the first into Egypt to reside there; then the Assyrian oppressed them without cause.

Now therefore, what do I have here," declares the LORD, "seeing that my people have been taken away without cause?" Again the LORD declares, "Those who rule over them howl, and my name is continually blasphemed all day long.

Therefore my people shall know my name; therefore in that day I am the one who is speaking, 'Here I am.'"

Ezekiel 36 is a particularly potent example of this theme.

### Ezekiel 36:17-36 Instructor's Translation

<sup>17</sup> "Son of man, when the house of Israel was living in their own land, they defiled it by their ways and their deeds. ... <sup>18</sup> Therefore I poured out my wrath on them for the blood which they had shed on the land, because they had defiled it with their idols. <sup>19</sup> Also I scattered them among the nations and they were dispersed throughout the lands. ...

<sup>20</sup> When they came to the nations where they went, **they profaned my holy name**, because it was said of them, 'These are the people of Yahweh; yet they had to go out of his land.'

<sup>21</sup> But I had concern for **my holy name**, which the house of Israel had profaned among the nations where they went.

<sup>22</sup> Therefore say to the house of Israel, 'Thus says the Lord God, "It is not for your sake, O house of Israel, that I am about to act, but for **my holy name, which you have profaned** among the nations where you went.

<sup>23</sup> I will vindicate **the holiness of my great name which has been profaned** among the nations, which you have profaned in their midst. Then the nations will know that I am Yahweh," declares the Lord God, "when I prove myself holy among you in their sight.

<sup>24</sup> For I will take you from the nations, gather you from all the lands and bring you into your own land. <sup>25</sup> Then I will sprinkle clean water on you, and you will be purified. ...

<sup>26</sup> Moreover, I will give you a new heart and put a new spirit within you; and I will remove the heart of stone from your flesh and give you a heart of flesh. <sup>27</sup> I will put my Spirit within you and cause you to walk in my statutes, and you will be careful to observe my ordinances. ...

<sup>30</sup> I will multiply the fruit of the tree and the produce of the field, so that you will not receive again the disgrace of famine among the nations. ...

<sup>34</sup> The desolate land will be cultivated instead of being a desolation in the sight of everyone who passes by.

<sup>35</sup> They will say, 'This desolate land has become like the garden of Eden; and the waste, desolate and ruined cities are fortified and inhabited.'

<sup>36</sup> Then **the nations that are left round about you will know that I, Yahweh**, have rebuilt the ruined places and planted that which was desolate; I, Yahweh, have spoken and will do it."

In other words, Jesus' petition that God's name be reinstated to a place of uniqueness and honor is a request that God act in history to accomplish redemption, to carry out his plan to restore Israel and fulfill his covenant plan that will spread through them to all nations.

## Kingdom Come

The "Kingdom of God" was the main theme in Jesus' teaching, and he claimed that in his actions, God's Kingdom was actually becoming reality here on earth.

- Mark 1:15: "the Kingdom of God has arrived."
- Matthew 12:28: "Hey everyone, God is now starting to run the show!"

In the Hebrew Bible, the "kingdom" of God refers to God's realm of dominion and authority. In one sense, all of creation is God's Kingdom.

### Psalm 103:19 Instructor's Translation

The Lord has established **his throne in the skies**,  
and **his kingdom** rules over all.

### Psalm 145:10-13 NASB

All your works shall give thanks to you, O LORD,  
and your godly ones shall bless you.  
They shall speak of **the glory of your kingdom**  
and talk of your power;  
to make known to the sons of men your mighty acts  
and the glory of the majesty of **your kingdom**.  
**Your kingdom is an everlasting kingdom**,  
and your dominion endures throughout all generations.

### Daniel 4:2-3 NASB

It has seemed good to me to declare the signs and wonders which the Most High God has done for me.  
How great are his signs and how mighty are his wonders!  
**His kingdom is an everlasting kingdom** and his dominion is from generation to generation.

### Daniel 4:34 NASB

But at the end of that period, I, Nebuchadnezzar, raised my eyes toward heaven and my reason returned to me, and I blessed the Most High and praised and honored him who lives forever; for his dominion is an everlasting dominion, and **his kingdom endures from generation to generation**.

"Kingdom of God/Heaven" does not mean "going to heaven." Just the opposite, it is an announcement that God's space is coming into contact with our space.

God's "Kingdom" and "will": What would it look like if God were running this show? If the world were as the creator intended it to be, and wants it to be again: a place of *shalom*, justice, abundance, community, etc.?



The biblical authors use the term “new/renewed creation” to speak of this future hope (Rom. 8:18-23; Rev. 21-22), and of how this future hope has begun to infiltrate the present (2 Cor. 5:17).

The idea of God’s heavenly reign becoming realized on earth is what Daniel 7 is all about.

#### **Daniel 7:13–14 Instructor’s Translation**

I kept looking in the night visions,  
and behold, with the clouds of heaven  
one like a Son of Man was coming,  
and he came up to the Ancient of Days  
and was presented before him.  
And to **him was given dominion** (שָׁלָטָן),  
glory and **a kingdom** (מַלְכוּת),  
that all the peoples, nations, and men of every language  
might serve him.  
His dominion is an everlasting dominion  
which will not pass away;  
and **his Kingdom** is one  
which will not be destroyed.

#### **Daniel 7:18 Instructor’s Translation**

But the saints of the Highest One will receive **the Kingdom**  
and possess **the Kingdom** forever,  
for all ages to come.

#### **Daniel 7:27 NASB**

Then the sovereignty, the dominion and the greatness of all the kingdoms under the whole heaven  
will be given to the people of the saints of the Highest One;  
**his Kingdom will be an everlasting kingdom, and all the dominions** will serve and obey him.

In the Gospel of Matthew, the story begins with a conflict of kingdoms, as the first three uses of the word make clear.

#### **Matthew 3:1–2 Instructor’s Translation**

Now in those days John the Baptist came, preaching in the wilderness of Judea, saying,  
“Repent, for **the kingdom of the skies** has come near.”

#### **Matthew 4:8–9 Instructor’s Translation**

Again, the slanderer took him to a very high mountain and showed him all **the kingdoms of the world** and  
their glory and he said to him, “All these things I will give you, if you fall down and worship me.”

#### **Matthew 4:17 Instructor’s Translation**

From that time Jesus began to preach and say, “Repent, for **the kingdom of the skies** is at hand.”

The word “kingdom” (Greek: *basilea*) occurs 55 times in Matthew’s account.

## The Kingdom Is Present With Jesus

### Matthew 4:17 NASB

From that time Jesus began to preach and say, "Repent, for **the kingdom of the skies has come near.**"

### Matthew 10:6-7 NASB

but rather go to the lost sheep of the house of Israel.

And as you go, preach, saying, "**The kingdom of the skies has come near.**"

### Matthew 12:28 NASB

But if I cast out demons by the Spirit of God, then **the kingdom of God has come upon you.**

### Matthew 18:3-4 NASB

and said, "Truly I say to you, unless you are converted and become like children, **you will not enter the kingdom of the skies.** Whoever then humbles himself as this child, **he is the greatest in the kingdom of the skies.**"

### Matthew 19:23-24 NASB

And Jesus said to his disciples, "Truly I say to you, it is hard for a rich man **to enter the kingdom of the skies.**

Again I say to you, it is easier for a camel to go through the eye of a needle, than for a rich man **to enter the kingdom of God.**"

### Matthew 21:31 NIV

"Which of the two did what his father wanted?" "The first," they answered. Jesus said to them, "Truly I tell you, the **tax collectors and the prostitutes are entering the kingdom of God ahead of you.**"

## The Kingdom Is Yet Future

### Matthew 8:11 Instructor's Translation

I say to you that **many will come** from east and west, and **will recline** at the table with Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob **in the kingdom of the skies;**"

### Matthew 13:43 NASB

Then **the righteous will shine forth** as the sun **in the kingdom of their Father.** He who has ears, let him hear.

### Matthew 16:28 NASB

"Truly I say to you, there are some of those who are standing here who will not taste death **until they see the Son of Man coming in his kingdom.**"

### Matthew 26:27-29 NASB

And when he had taken a cup and given thanks, he gave it to them, saying, "Drink from it, all of you; for this is my blood of the covenant, which is poured out for many for forgiveness of sins.

But I say to you, **I will not drink of this fruit of the vine from now on until that day when I drink it new with you in my Father's kingdom.**"

In the teachings of Jesus, the arrival of the Kingdom is not merely a future hope. God has begun to bring his Kingdom into realization here and now in Jesus' actions and teachings (healings, forgiveness, celebration, challenges to injustice) and in the mission of Jesus and the movement he has begun (i.e., the book of Acts and beyond).

"What would it look like if God was running this show?" To this question, Jesus' mission offered a glimpse. There will be a party, with the poor and marginalized invited. It would look like a leper and outcast getting healed and reintegrated into society. It will look like people encountering Jesus and finding out what it means to be human in a fresh, new way.

What does it mean to live this part of the prayer? It is not a petition that allows us to be passive. It is a confession that God's Kingdom, God's way of running the universe, has arrived in Jesus, and we are to follow suit. Not that we can redo what Jesus has done. What Jesus did for the world, he did once and for all. However, we are to implement that accomplishment.

Jesus is a musician who wrote the greatest symphony of all time. We are bit musicians, who have become captivated by his work and now learn to play the symphony in a world full of elevator music and easy listening radio. Or Jesus is the medical genius who has discovered penicillin. We are now doctors who have been cured by the medicine, and we must now go and apply it to those in need.

But what we play must be Jesus' music: "Those who long for God's will on earth in the future should live consistently with that longing in the present, working for God's justice and seeking his will here and now."

When we pray this part of the prayer, we are expressing both the love and grief of the creator for his battered world. It is a prayer for the world's redemption and renewal. We are praying Jesus' prayer that he put into action. If we pray this way, we must be prepared to start living this way.

This is not a prayer of resignation but of commission: Make us a community of healed healers, of Kingdom musicians who listen to the music ourselves in prayer and scripture and then play the music of the cross and forgiveness, of grace and a new chance at life.

## Will Be Done

God's "will" (Greek: *thelema*, θέλημα): This Greek word is often used in the Septuagint to render Hebrew *khephets* / כֶּפֶץ "desire, intended purpose."

### 1 Kings 5:8-10 NASB

So Hiram sent word to Solomon, saying, "I have heard the message which you have sent me; I will do **what you desire** concerning the cedar and cypress timber. My servants will bring them down from Lebanon to the sea; and I will make them into rafts to go by sea to the place where you direct me, and I will have them broken up there, and you shall carry them away. Then you shall accomplish **my desire** by giving food to my household."

So Hiram gave Solomon as much as **he desired** of the cedar and cypress timber.

## 2 Chronicles 9:12 NASB

King Solomon gave to the queen of Sheba **all her desire** which she requested besides a return for what she had brought to the king. Then she turned and went to her own land with her servants.

## Psalms 1:2 NASB

But his **delight** is in the law of the Lord,  
and in his law he meditates day and night.

## Psalms 40:7-8 NASB

Then I said, "Behold, I come;  
in the scroll of the book it is written of me.  
I delight to do **your will**, O my God;  
your Law is within my heart."

## Psalms 103:19-21 NASB

The Lord has established **his throne in the heavens,  
and his sovereignty rules over all.**  
Bless the Lord, you his angels,  
mighty in strength, who perform his word,  
obeying the voice of his word!  
Bless the Lord, all you his hosts,  
you who serve him, **doing his will.**

## Isaiah 48:14 Instructor's Translation

Assemble, all of you, and listen!  
Who among them has declared these things?  
The Lord loves him; he will carry out **his desire** on Babylon,  
and his arm will be against the Chaldeans.

## Isaiah 58:13 NASB

If because of the sabbath, you turn your foot from doing **your own desire** on my holy day, and call the sabbath a delight, the holy day of the Lord honorable, and honor it, desisting from your own ways, from seeking your own pleasure and speaking your own word,

It cannot be coincidence that Jesus here uses a word that activates a theme that began in the Eden narrative, about the "will/desire" of humans that can set itself up in opposition to the will/desire of God.

## Genesis 3:6 Instructor's Translation

When the woman saw that the tree was good for food  
and **desirable** (Hebrew: תאוה / Greek: ἀρεστός) to see with the eyes,  
and **desirable** (Hebrew: נחמד / Greek: ὡραῖος) for gaining wisdom,  
then she took and she ate ...

In Matthew in particular, this key word “will, desire” (θέλημά) is repeated at key points in the narrative (which is fascinating, given that this phrase in the Lord’s Prayer is unique to Matthew when compared with Luke).

#### **Matthew 7:21 NASB**

Not everyone who says to me, “Lord, Lord,” will enter the kingdom of heaven, but **he who does the will of my Father** who is in heaven will enter.

#### **Matthew 12:49–50 NASB**

And stretching out his hand toward his disciples, he said, “Behold my mother and my brothers! For **whoever does the will of my Father** who is in heaven, he is my brother and sister and mother.”

#### **Matthew 18:13–14 NASB**

If it turns out that he finds it, truly I say to you, he rejoices over it more than over the ninety-nine which have not gone astray. So **it is not the will of your Father** who is in heaven that one of these little ones perish.

#### **Matthew 21:28–31 NASB**

“But what do you think? A man had two sons, and he came to the first and said, ‘Son, go work today in the vineyard.’

And he answered, ‘I will not’; but afterward he regretted it and went.

The man came to the second and said the same thing; and he answered, ‘I will, sir’; but he did not go.

Which of the two **did the will of his father?**” They said, “The first.” Jesus said to them, “Truly I say to you that the tax collectors and prostitutes will get into the kingdom of God before you.”

#### **Matthew 26:40–42 NASB**

And he came to the disciples and found them sleeping, and said to Peter, “So, you men could not keep watch with me for one hour?

Keep watching and praying that you may **not enter into temptation; the spirit is willing**, but the flesh is weak.”

He went away again a second time and prayed, saying, “My Father, if this cannot pass away unless I drink it, **may your will be done.**”

## **Daily Bread**

Note how the prayer begins with a focus on God’s Kingdom, what the creator wants to do with his world. This is a prayer that his plan advances first. Then the prayer turns to our needs.

“Give us today our daily bread” is a declaration of trust in God for one’s life, sustenance, and provision. This is likely an allusion back to the story of the Israelites eating the manna in the wilderness after being redeemed from Egyptian slavery ([Exod. 16](#)).

The manna story became, in Jewish culture, a well-known image of God’s provision for his people in times of hardship. The key line, to which Jesus is alluding here, is found in Exodus 16:4.

#### **Exodus 16:4 NASB**

Then the LORD said to Moses, “Behold, I will rain **bread from heaven** for you; and the people shall go out and **gather a day’s portion every day**, that I may test them, whether or not they will walk in my instruction.”

#### **Exodus 16:22 NASB**

Now **on the sixth day** they gathered twice as much bread, two omers for each one. When all the leaders of the congregation came and told Moses,

#### **Exodus 16:29 NASB**

See, the LORD has given you **the sabbath**; therefore he gives you **bread for two days on the sixth day**. Remain every man in his place; let no man go out of his place on the seventh day.

“Just as Jesus resisted the first temptation to turn stones into bread by trusting God to supply his bread in the wilderness (Matthew 4:3-4), so also must his followers. This prayer ... expresses dependence on God for daily bread, a willingness to live simply, satisfied with the basics. This prayer is most naturally uttered by the poor, a condition that characterized many Galilean peasants who followed Jesus.”

Keener, Craig S. (2009). [\*The Gospel of Matthew: A Socio-Rhetorical Commentary\*](#). Eerdmans. 222.

The prayer for daily bread is connected with the passage ahead in [6:31-33](#). If we are truly seeking a Kingdom lifestyle, then our priorities shift, and life necessities become a matter of reliance instead of consumption.

“What transforms society in Jesus’ ideal is knowing God as the utterly reliable and endlessly generous provider of all good, on whom all creatures are completely dependent. ... The kind of trust in God’s provision that Jesus envisaged is enshrined in one petition of the Lord’s prayer: ‘Give us this day our daily bread.’ Adequate provision for material needs, not luxury, and day-by-day provision, not wealth stored up, are all that is asked. It puts the disciple of Jesus in the position of the beggars, who depend day-by-day on charity, or of the day laborer, those agricultural workers who had the least security, employed only a day at a time, never earning more than the next day’s meal. Jesus requires of all disciples, the radical trust that for the destitute is the only sort available.”

Bauckham, Richard (2011). [\*Jesus: A Very Short Introduction\*](#). Oxford University Press. 79.

There is a long-standing difficulty in understanding the meaning of the Greek word *epiousios*, usually translated as “daily bread,” as it is used only here in the New Testament.

Literally, the Greek reads:

- [Matthew 6:11](#)—Our bread of *epiousios*, give us today (*semeron*).
- [Luke 11:3](#)—Our bread of *epiousios*, give us each day (*kat’ emeran*).

There are a handful of interpretations of *epiousios*:

- “what is necessary for life”
- “for the current day”
- “for the coming day” (realized eschatology interpretation)

Entry *epiousios* from the New International Dictionary of New Testament Theology and Exegesis.

“NT This unusual term is linked with ἄρτος G788, ‘bread,’ in the fourth petition of the Lord’s Prayer (Matt. 6:11;



Luke 11:3). Otherwise the word occurs only once in a papyrus of the 5th cent. AD, and even this occurrence is doubtful (see esp. M. Nijman and K. A. Worp, “Ἐπιούσιος in a Documentary Papyrus?” *NovT* 41 [1999]: 231–34). Hence the transl. and interpretation of the term has been a matter of controversy from early times, though the rendering “daily” is found already in Tertullian (2nd cent. AD). Four possibilities emerge from the long debate.

1 Some relate the term to the expression ἡ ἐπιούσα ἡμέρα, “the coming day,” i.e., “the next day” (cf. Acts 7:26 [without ἡμέρα in 16:11 et al.; cf. also Prov. 27:1]; the form here is the ptc. of ἐπιμι G2079, “to come upon, approach”). Jerome claims that the version of the Lord’s Prayer in the Gospel of the Hebrews had the word מָחָר H4737 (“the next day, tomorrow”). In that case ἐπιούσιος ἄρτος would mean “bread for tomorrow.” It may be thought that praying for tomorrow’s bread contradicts Matt. 6:34 (“do not worry about tomorrow”), but the expression perhaps indicates “the coming day” in a general sense (the meaning “pertaining to the coming day” is ably defended by C. J. Hemer, “Ἐπιούσιος,” *JSNT* 7 no. 22 [1984]: 81–94). One should remember, however, that there is no persuasive evidence that the Gospel of the Hebrews preserves the orig. text; it is more likely a retroversion (i.e., secondary transl. from Gk. into Heb.).

2 Origen suggested that the word derives from a different phrase, ἐπὶ τῇ οὐσίᾳ; the term οὐσία G4045 (orig. the ptc. of εἶμι G1639, “to be”) means “being, existence, substance,” and so, according to this view, the prayer is a request for “the bread necessary for existence.” Origen, one of the greatest scholars of the 3rd cent., spoke Gk. as his mother tongue, so this interpretation should not be dismissed quickly. The idea can certainly be supported by a passage such as Prov. 30:8 (a prayer for חֶלֶם לִי, “the food that I need” [NRSV]), and it reminds us of the manna, which the Israelites were to gather on a daily basis (Exod. 16:4; cf. Str-B 1:420–21; see μάννα G3445).

3 J. Jeremias (*The Prayers of Jesus* [1967], 98–104) takes the first interpretation and reinterprets it in terms of the final consummation: the morrow that Jesus had in mind is not the next day, but the great morning of the final fulfillment—the day when Jesus with his disciples will eat the bread of life, the heavenly manna, in eternity (Matt 26:29; Luke 22:30; Rev. 2:17). The disciples were to pray for this bread. The church fathers sim. linked the fourth petition with Christ, who imparts himself in the Lord’s Supper as “the bread of life” (John 6:35). Although these gifts for salvation may indeed be included in the fourth petition, it seems difficult to deny, in the light of Matt. 6:25–33, that Jesus was thinking first of all of earthly bread (cf. R. T. France, *The Gospel of Matthew* [2007], 249).

4 K. G. Kuhn (*Achtzehngebet und Vaterunser und der Reim* [1950]) believes that whoever translated Jesus’ Aram. prayer into Gk. chose the otherwise unknown term ἐπιούσιος to bring out a special stress in the orig. prayer. According to this view, the Aram. expression ܐܪܬܝܢܐ had a double meaning that could be expressed in Gk. only by combining two terms: ἐπιούσιος, insofar as the bread is needed “for the day,” and σήμερον G3814, “for today.” Then the daily prayer for bread sufficing for the day would not merely be a constant reminder to the disciples of God’s fatherly faithfulness. It would also remind them that in the new age, which had already begun and whose consummation could be expected at any time, prayer for provision for a longer period should no longer concern the disciples. (For other possibilities, see BDAG s.v.)”

Zondervan Academic (2014). [New International Dictionary of New Testament Theology and Exegesis](#). Zondervan Academic.

## Forgiveness

“Forgive us our debts/sins, as we have forgiven ... ”

- “Forgive” = Greek verb *aphiemi* / ἀφίημι “to release, let someone go” or the noun *aphesis* / ἄφεσις “release, letting go”
- “To release from one’s presence”: “Then Jesus released the crowds and went into the house” (Matt. 13:36)
- “To release from obligation, to cancel or forgive a debt”

“The noun ἄφεσις is first attested in Greek literature from the 5th cent. BC, is less common, and its uses are less varied, but the sense “a letting go, release” seems basic and also finds application in legal contexts (Plato Leg. 869d; Demosth. Timocr. [= Or. 24] 45, of remission of debt). It should be noted, however, that the terms are found only in the setting of human relationships and not used in a religious sense.”

Zondervan Academic (2014). [\*New International Dictionary of New Testament Theology and Exegesis\*](#). Zondervan Academic.

In the Greek Septuagint translation of the Hebrew Bible, the noun “release” (*aphesis*) is used 50 times, and nearly half of these occur in the translation of Leviticus to render the word “Jubilee” (Hebrew: *yovail* / יבֵּל), referring to the “year of release” when all debts were cancelled in Israel. The appropriate translation here is “freedom, emancipation.”

Matthew’s version has the word “debts” (Greek: *opheilemata*) here, used also of financial debts in day-to-day life. Luke’s version reads “sins” (Greek: *hamartia*). These are two metaphors that describe the same reality.

In early Judaism, the word “debt”, used in describing one’s relationship with God, is equivalent to “sin”. It describes behavior that vandalizes *shalom* in God’s world, that violates other people, and makes one a debtor to the creator. You now owe God for the wrong you’ve done.

“Sin” is to miss the goal, to fail at fulfilling one’s purpose, which is to fully love God and others.

In the Hebrew Bible, Israel’s sins are not simply failure to live up to God’s moral standards. They are violations of their covenant with Yahweh, and so their failures build up a “debt” that must be paid through the consequences for covenant unfaithfulness. In the Torah, these consequences are the covenant curses seen in Leviticus 26 and Deuteronomy 28. Such consequences include:

- Scarcity instead of abundance (famine)
- Sickness instead of health
- Short lifespan instead of long life
- Defeat, slavery, and exile instead of victory, rule, and security

Israel’s prophets viewed the exile and the ongoing oppression under foreign empires after the exile as the ongoing sign that Israel’s sin/debt still needed to be dealt with. In this perspective, forgiveness is both individual and corporate, and fits within the story of Israel’s restoration.

### **Micah 6:9–16 NLT**

<sup>9</sup> Fear the Lord if you are wise! His voice calls to everyone in Jerusalem: “The armies of destruction are coming; the Lord is sending them.

<sup>10</sup> What shall I say about the homes of the wicked filled with treasures gained by cheating? What about the disgusting practice of measuring out grain with dishonest measures?



<sup>11</sup> How can I tolerate your merchants who use dishonest scales and weights?

<sup>12</sup> The rich among you have become wealthy through extortion and violence. Your citizens are so used to lying that their tongues can no longer tell the truth.

<sup>13</sup> “Therefore, I will wound you! **I will bring you to ruin for all your sins.**

<sup>14</sup> You will eat but never have enough. Your hunger pangs and emptiness will remain. And though you try to save your money, it will come to nothing in the end. You will save a little, but I will give it to those who conquer you.

<sup>15</sup> You will plant crops but not harvest them. You will press your olives but not get enough oil to anoint yourselves. You will trample the grapes but get no juice to make your wine.

<sup>16</sup> You keep only the laws of evil King Omri; you follow only the example of wicked King Ahab! Therefore, I will make an example of you, bringing you to complete ruin. You will be treated with contempt, mocked by all who see you.”

### **Micah 7:18–20 NLT**

Where is another God like you, **who pardons the guilt of the remnant, overlooking the sins** of his special people? You will not stay angry with your people forever, because you delight in showing unfailing love. Once again you will have compassion on us. **You will trample our sins under your feet and throw them into the depths of the ocean!** You will show us your faithfulness and unfailing love as you promised to our ancestors Abraham and Jacob long ago.

### **Jeremiah 31:31–34 NLT**

“The day is coming,” says the LORD, “when I will make a new covenant with the people of Israel and Judah. This covenant will not be like the one I made with their ancestors when I took them by the hand and brought them out of the land of Egypt. **They broke that covenant,** though I loved them as a husband loves his wife,” says the LORD.

**“But this is the new covenant I will make** with the people of Israel after those days,” says the LORD. “I will put my instructions deep within them, and I will write them on their hearts. I will be their God, and they will be my people. And they will not need to teach their neighbors, nor will they need to teach their relatives, saying, ‘You should know the LORD.’ For everyone, from the least to the greatest, will know me already,” says the LORD. “And I will forgive their wickedness, and I will never again remember their sins.”

For other, similar descriptions of sin and forgiveness in the prophets, see [Hosea 1-3](#)

Jesus’ emphasis on forgiveness as a key marker of his new covenant communities must be seen in this particular Jewish-biblical context.

We must view the petition for forgiveness in the Lord’s Prayer in the context of Jesus’ mission to Israel. To announce Israel’s long history of failure to fulfill their end of the covenant, a failure that landed them in exile and oppression under empires, this failure has been forgiven. Through Jesus, the Kingdom of God has arrived with a great offer of forgiveness for past wrongs.

This forgiveness theme pervades Luke’s presentation of Jesus.

### **Luke 1:67–79 NLT**

<sup>67</sup> Then his father, Zechariah, was filled with the Holy Spirit and gave this prophecy:  
<sup>68</sup> “Praise the Lord, the God of Israel, because he has visited and redeemed his people.  
<sup>69</sup> He has sent us a mighty Savior from the royal line of his servant David,  
<sup>70</sup> just as he promised through his holy prophets long ago.  
<sup>71</sup> Now we will be saved from our enemies and from all who hate us.  
<sup>72</sup> He has been merciful to our ancestors by remembering his sacred covenant—  
<sup>73</sup> the covenant he swore with an oath to our ancestor Abraham.  
<sup>74</sup> We have been rescued from our enemies so we can serve God without fear,  
<sup>75</sup> in holiness and righteousness for as long as we live.  
<sup>76</sup> And you, my little son, will be called the prophet of the Most High, because you will prepare the way for the Lord.  
<sup>77</sup> You will tell his people how to find deliverance **through forgiveness of their sins**.  
<sup>78</sup> Because of God’s tender mercy, the morning light from heaven is about to break upon us,  
<sup>79</sup> to give light to those who sit in darkness and in the shadow of death, and to guide us to the path of peace.”

#### **Luke 4:16–19 NIV\***

He went to Nazareth, where he had been brought up, and on the Sabbath day he went into the synagogue, as was his custom. He stood up to read, and the scroll of the prophet Isaiah was handed to him. Unrolling it, he found the place where it is written:  
“The Spirit of the Lord is on me, because he has anointed me to proclaim good news to the poor. He has sent me to proclaim **aphesis** for the prisoners and recovery of sight for the blind, to send out the oppressed in **aphesis**, to proclaim the year of the Lord’s favor.”

Key Words Adapted by Teacher

#### **Luke 5:23–24 NASB**

“Which is easier, to say, ‘**Your sins have been forgiven,**’ or to say, ‘Get up and walk’?  
But, so that you may know that the Son of Man has authority on earth to **forgive sins,**”—he said to the paralytic—“I say to you, get up, and pick up your stretcher and go home.”

#### **Luke 13:11–16 NASB**

<sup>11</sup> And there was a woman who for eighteen years had had a sickness caused by a spirit; and she was bent double, and could not straighten up at all.  
<sup>12</sup> When Jesus saw her, he called her over and said to her, “Woman, **you are freed (Greek: *apoluein*) from your sickness.**”  
<sup>13</sup> And he laid his hands on her; and immediately she was made erect again and began glorifying God.  
<sup>14</sup> But the synagogue official, indignant because Jesus had healed on the Sabbath, began saying to the crowd in response, “There are six days in which work should be done; so come during them and get healed, and not on the Sabbath day.”  
<sup>15</sup> But the Lord answered him and said, “You hypocrites, does not each of you on the Sabbath untie his ox or his donkey from the stall and lead him away to water him?”

<sup>16</sup> “And this woman, a daughter of Abraham as she is, whom Satan has bound for eighteen long years, should she not have been released from this bond on the Sabbath day?”

The comparison “as we have forgiven ...” highlights a key theme in Jesus’ teaching: Reciprocal forgiveness for all (see the parable in [Matthew 18:21-35](#)).

Forgiveness in Judaism was accomplished by offering sacrifices in the temple. Jesus, on the other hand, claimed to offer God’s forgiveness directly, without going to the temple (see [Mark 2:1-12](#)).

Jesus was essentially saying that God’s forgiveness is available outside of the official religious institutions people had grown up with: the priests in the temple do not have a monopoly on God’s grace.

This part of the prayer is expanded upon in [Matthew 6:14-15](#): “For if you forgive others for their transgressions, your heavenly Father will also forgive you. But if you do not forgive others, then your Father will not forgive your transgressions.”

This saying is often misunderstood because it seems to attach a condition on God’s grace, namely that we have to forgive in order to be forgiven.

These verses are actually getting at something far more profound: The economy of forgiveness in the Kingdom of God is fully reciprocal.

- God’s forgiveness cannot be received by someone who refuses to forgive others.
- Our ability to forgive others is directly connected to our ability to acknowledge that we need forgiveness ourselves.

The point does not have to do with what one deserves, but with desire. God’s forgiveness, although we cannot earn it, must be received, and someone who refuses to forgive others cannot truly receive forgiveness.

Our ability to extend grace to others is directly connected to our ability to accept God’s grace extended to us. The one is evidence of the other.

## **Pastoral Clarification on Forgiveness**

If we meditate on the teachings of Jesus about forgiveness, especially those found in [Matthew 5](#) and [Matthew 18](#) and [Luke 6](#), you will find that Jesus’ practice of forgiveness is very specific.

For him, forgiveness is NOT:

- ignoring or forgetting
- condoning or excusing
- tolerating or allowing further abuse
- the same as reconciliation or restoration
- allowing the offender to escape consequences

According to Jesus, you never have to be in the same room, you don’t have to forget. You can make sure there are consequences for their wrong ... and still forgive someone. Those things are not the opposite of forgiveness.

In Jesus' teaching on forgiveness in Matthew 18, if someone wrongs you, then you go directly to that person (not to others!) and share honestly. If they don't acknowledge what they've done, bring a small number of others (he mentions two or three), so they can mediate (maybe you're off-base, or maybe the other person is). If that group comes to agree that the other person wronged you, and if the person won't acknowledge it, then separate from that person. You shouldn't be around them at all.

However, all of that said, Jesus says that forgiveness can still take place, even if you can't reconcile with the person.

In the parable about the guy forgiven of a huge debt who won't forgive his friend of a small debt, Jesus locates forgiveness "in the heart" (Matt. 18:35). It's about a heart posture toward another who wronged me, in light of the fact that I also stand in need of forgiveness from others and from God. There is no high ground here from which I can legitimately deny another person forgiveness.

For Jesus, forgiveness is one of the ways God's reign and desire arrive on the land as it is in the skies.

## Deliverance From the Test

"Don't lead us into the trial/testing, but deliver us from the evil one" (Matt. 6:13).

Our English translations are not helpful here, by translating this term as "temptation" (NIV, NAS). The Greek word is *peirasmos*.

- "Temptation" infers (1) someone who is doing the tempting, which in this case would be God, and (2) "tempting" in English means that the "tempter" intends the "tempted" to succumb. This is simply not what Jesus is talking about. (It is likely James 1:13-18 is trying to avoid this misinterpretation of the Lord's Prayer.)
- Temptation=to be enticed to moral failure. The purpose of temptation is negative.
- Testing=to be faced with circumstances that prove one's commitment and character, also known as faithfulness. The purpose of testing is positive, to reveal the truth about one's character.
- A better translation would be "testing," "trial," or "difficult ordeal."

This links into a major theme in the melodic cycle of the Hebrew Bible, where God blesses his chosen ones with abundance, fertility, status, and responsibility. That blessing brings the character to a moment of decision as to whether they will trust God and so retain the blessing.

The decision is often about how they will respond to something God has said, commanded, or promised. The character either succeeds or fails the test, bringing some form of consequence, either negative (death, exile, estrangement, curse) or positive (rescue, provision, security, fertility, blessing).

The Hebrew Bible is a story of generations cycling through this melody: Jesus is here activating a core biblical theme that began with the Eden story: the test.

- Humanity's trust in God's generosity is tested by the command regarding the tree of knowing good and bad (Gen. 3).
- Noah's trust in God's wisdom is tested by the command to make a box-boat (Gen. 6).
- Abram's trust in God's ability to bless is tested by his call to leave his land and family and go to a new land to experience blessing (Gen. 12).

- Israel's trust in God's salvation is tested by the call to walk into the deadly waters (Exod. 14).
- Israel's trust in God's power to bless is tested by the call to journey through the wilderness without food or water (Exod. 15-17).
- The purpose of Israel's testing in the wilderness was a major focus in the Torah. Moses reflects on this in Deuteronomy 8.

#### **Deuteronomy 8:1-5 Instructor's Translation**

<sup>1</sup> All the commandments that I am commanding you today you shall be careful to do, so that you can live and multiply, and go in and possess the land which the Lord swore to give to your forefathers.

<sup>2</sup> You shall remember all the way which the Lord your God has led you, in the wilderness **these forty years**, in order to humble you,

**in order to test you,**

**in order to know what was in your heart,**

whether you would keep his commandments or not.

<sup>3</sup> and he humbled you and let you be hungry, and he fed you with manna which you did not know, nor did your fathers know, so that he might make you understand that a human does not live by bread alone, rather a human lives by everything that proceeds out of the mouth of the Lord.

<sup>4</sup> Your clothing did not wear out on you, nor did your foot swell these forty years.

<sup>5</sup> Thus you are to know in your heart that the Lord your God was disciplining you, just as a man disciplines his son.

Within the Hebrew Bible, God gives generous gifts to his chosen covenant partners, but then allows them opportunities to show their loyalty in return.

In Second Temple Judaism and early Christianity, this was a common theme, knowing that sometimes God tests the endurance of his faithful ones.

#### **Hebrews 4:14-16 Instructor's Translation**

Therefore, since we have a great high priest who has passed through the heavens, Jesus the Son of God, let us hold fast our confession.

For we do not have a high priest who cannot sympathize with our weaknesses, but one who has been **tested** in all things as we are, yet without sin.

Therefore let us draw near with confidence to the throne of grace, so that we may receive mercy and find grace to help in time of need.

#### **1 Corinthians 10:1-13 NASB**

<sup>1</sup> For I do not want you to be unaware, brethren, that our fathers were all under the cloud and all passed through the sea;

<sup>2</sup> and all were baptized into Moses in the cloud and in the sea;

<sup>3</sup> and all ate the same spiritual food;

<sup>4</sup> and all drank the same spiritual drink,

for they were drinking from a spiritual rock which followed them;  
and the rock was the Messiah.

<sup>5</sup> Nevertheless, with most of them God was not well-pleased;  
for they were laid low in the wilderness.

<sup>6</sup> Now these things happened as examples for us,  
so that we would not crave evil things as they also craved.

<sup>7</sup> Do not be idolaters, as some of them were; as it is written,  
“The people sat down to eat and drink, and stood up to play.”

<sup>8</sup> Nor let us act immorally, as some of them did, and twenty-three thousand fell in one day.

<sup>9</sup> **Nor let us test the Lord**, as some of them did, and were destroyed by the serpents.

<sup>10</sup> Nor grumble, as some of them did, and were destroyed by the destroyer.

<sup>11</sup> Now these things happened to them as an example,  
and they were written for our instruction,  
upon whom the ends of the ages have met together.

<sup>12</sup> Therefore let him who thinks he stands take heed that he does not fall.

<sup>13</sup> No **test** has overtaken you but such as is common to man;  
and God is faithful, who will not allow you to be **tested** beyond what you are able,  
but with the **test** will provide the way of escape also,  
so that you will be able to endure it.

The Gospel authors depict Jesus, after his baptism, as the Royal-Priest of Israel, enduring Israel’s tests on their behalf.

Jesus had to endure a test. The Spirit “led him” into the wilderness, where he faced his first test as he replayed Israel’s wilderness wanderings.

4:1 Then Jesus was led into the wilderness by **the spirit**,  
**to be tested** by **the slanderer**,

### Test 1

A <sup>2</sup> and having **fasted** forty days and forty nights,  
afterward he was **hungry**,

B <sup>3</sup> and approaching, **the tester** said to him,  
“**If you are the son of God**,  
speak so that these stones become **loaves of bread**.”

**Deuteronomy 8:3**

C 4 And responding, he said,  
" **It has been written** ,  
'Not by **bread** alone does humanity live,  
but by every word that comes out from God's mouth.'

## Test 2

A' 5 Then **the slanderer** took him into **the holy city** ,  
and he stationed him at the upper tip of **the temple** ,

B' 6 and he said to him,  
" **If you are the son of God** ,  
throw yourself down,  
**for it has been written** ,  
'He has commanded his **messengers** concerning you,  
and they will lift you up in their hands,  
so that you won't strike your foot against a stone.'

### Deuteronomy 6:16

C' 7 Iesous said to him,  
"Again, **it has been written** ,  
'You will not **test** **the Lord your God** .'"

## Test 3

A" 8 Again, **the slanderer** took him to **a high mountain** ,  
and he showed him all the kingdoms of the world and their splendor,

B" 9 and he said to him,  
"All these things I will give to you,  
if, falling down, you will **bow down** to me."

### Deuteronomy 6:13

10 Then Iesous said to him,  
"Be gone, adversary!



For **it has been written**,  
'You will **bow down** to **the Lord your God**,  
and you will **serve** him only.'

<sup>11</sup> Then **the slanderer** left him,  
and look, **messengers** approached and ministered to him.

Matthew 4:1-11. Translation and Literary Design by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Rise of the Messiah (2024).

Jesus faced another test in Cesarea Philippi, but this time from one of his closest friends.

### **Matthew 16:13–25 NASB**

<sup>13</sup> Now when Jesus came into the district of Caesarea Philippi, he was asking his disciples, "Who do people say that the Son of Man is?"

<sup>14</sup> And they said, "Some say John the Baptist; and others, Elijah; but still others, Jeremiah, or one of the prophets."

<sup>15</sup> He said to them, "But who do you say that I am?"

<sup>16</sup> **Simon Peter answered, "You are the Christ, the Son of the living God."**

<sup>17</sup> And Jesus said to him,

**"Blessed are you, Simon Barjona,** because flesh and blood did not reveal this to you, but my Father who is in heaven ...

<sup>21</sup> From that time Jesus began to show his disciples that he must go to Jerusalem, and suffer many things from the elders and chief priests and scribes, and be killed, and be raised up on the third day.

<sup>22</sup> **Peter** took him aside and began to rebuke him, saying, **"God forbid it, Lord!** This shall never happen to you."

<sup>23</sup> But he turned and said to Peter,

**"Get behind me, Satan! (Greek: *hupage opiso mou satana*),**

You are a stumbling block to me; for you are not setting your mind on God's interests, but man's."

<sup>24</sup> Then Jesus said to his disciples, "If anyone wishes to come after me, he must deny himself, and take up his cross and follow me.

<sup>25</sup> "For whoever wishes to save his life will lose it; but whoever loses his life for my sake will find it.

Jesus actually used this language on another occasion, during his greatest test.

### **Matthew 26:36–42 NASB**

<sup>36</sup> Then Jesus came with them to a place called Gethsemane, and said to his disciples, "Sit here while I go over there and pray."

<sup>37</sup> And he took with him Peter and the two sons of Zebedee, and began to be grieved and distressed.

<sup>38</sup> Then he said to them, “My soul is deeply grieved, to the point of death; remain here and keep watch with me.”

<sup>39</sup> And he went a little beyond them, and fell on his face and prayed, saying, “My Father, if it is possible, let this cup pass from me; **yet not as I will, but as you will.**”

<sup>40</sup> And he came to the disciples and found them sleeping, and said to Peter, “So, you men could not keep watch with me for one hour?

<sup>41</sup> Keep watching and praying **that you may not enter into the test**; the spirit is willing, but the flesh is weak.”

<sup>42</sup> He went away again a second time and prayed, saying, “My Father, if this cannot pass away unless I drink it, **may your will be done.**”

James’ gives clarification on “testing/tempting” in James 1.

#### **James 1:2–4 NASB\***

Consider it all joy, my brethren, when you encounter various **peirasmos**, knowing that the proving of your faith produces endurance.

And let endurance have its complete result, so that you may be complete and whole, lacking in nothing.

Key Words Adapted by Teacher

#### **James 1:12–17 NASB\***

<sup>12</sup> Blessed is the one who perseveres under **peirasmos**; for once they have proved themselves, they will receive the crown of life which the Lord has promised to those who love him.

<sup>13</sup> Let no one say when he is tempted, “I am being tempted by God”; for God cannot be tempted by evil, and he himself does not tempt anyone.

<sup>14</sup> But each one is tempted when he is carried away and enticed by his own lust.

<sup>15</sup> Then when lust has conceived, it gives birth to sin; and when sin is accomplished, it brings forth death.

<sup>16</sup> Do not be deceived, my beloved brethren.

<sup>17</sup> Every good thing given and every perfect gift is from above, coming down from the Father of lights, with whom there is no variation or shifting shadow.

Key Words Adapted by Teacher

This is a meditation on the “test” theme in [Genesis 2-3](#), but clarified so that James’ audience doesn’t misunderstand the character of God in the Eden story.

Later manuscripts of Matthew include an additional ending that corresponds to the liturgical use of the prayer in the earliest generations of Jesus’ followers.

#### **Matthew 6:13 NIV**

... Because yours is the kingdom, the power and the glory forever, Amen.

This addition is found in later manuscripts of Matthew, but not in the earliest.

This addition corresponds to the form of the Lord's prayer found in one of the earliest Christian instructions on prayer, the *Didache* (from the 2nd century), which includes the following passage.

### **Didache 8:2-3**

"And do not pray as the wicked do;  
pray instead this way, as the Lord directed in his gospel:

Our Father who are in heaven,  
May your name be acclaimed as holy,  
May your kingdom come,  
May your will come to pass on earth as it does in heaven.  
Give us today our daily bread,  
And cancel for us our debt,  
As we cancel [debts] for those who are indebted to us,  
And do not bring us into the test,  
But preserve us from evil [or, from the evil one].  
For power and glory are yours forever.

Pray this way three times a day."

Niederwimmer, Kurt & Attridge, Harold W. (1998). [\*The Didache: A Commentary \(Hermeneia\)\*](#). Fortress Press. 134.

"It is important that the *Didache* contains a formulated doxology at the end of the prayer. Clearly, the form of the Our Father handed on by [Jesus] did not yet have such a doxology; it is lacking in the Lukan text and also in the original text of Matthew. Adolf Schlatter and Joachim Jeremias have instructed us, however, that the Our Father was one of the prayers 'with the "seal," i.e., with a freely formulated conclusion.' This means that, from the beginning, the one who prayed such prayers formulated a conclusion to the last petition *ex tempore*. It is in the nature of things that over time 'a fixed form of the doxology' was adopted. Such a fixed form for the doxology appears for the first time here in the *Didache*; it later emerges (although expanded; see below) in the 'majority text' of Matthew 6:13\* (Manuscripts L W Θ 0233 f13 m f q bopt). We do not know when and where these doxologies emerged. The passage in 1 Chr. 29:11–12\* that is often adduced as the model for them is too far removed in its wording. Rabbinic traditions also offer only analogies. Cf. the doxology: 'praised be the name of his glorious kingdom forever and ever.' This is how the priest and people respond to the great confession of sins in the temple cult (Str-B 1.423). The same benediction was spoken after the beginning of the Shema (Str-B, *ibid.*); compare also the Alenu prayer, whose conclusion is introduced by 'for thine is the kingdom' (Str-B, *ibid.*). The object of the benediction is always the kingdom, as is the beginning of the doxology to the Matthean Our Father as later attested by the 'majority text.' Here we should note that it is precisely this kingdom benediction, with which the later doxology of the Lord's Prayer in Matt. 6:13\* in the majority text begins, that is lacking in the *Didache*."

Niederwimmer, Kurt & Attridge, Harold W. (1998). [\*The Didache: A Commentary \(Hermeneia\)\*](#). Fortress Press. 134.

## Reflection Question

How does the Lord's Prayer reflect Jesus' own life?